

CLONTARF YACHT & BOAT CLUB

EAST COAST BILGE KEEL CHAMPIONSHIP

(Racing for: JIM MAGUIRE TROPHY)

Saturday 23rd August 2025 (re-scheduled)

SAILING INSTRUCTIONS

INTRODUCTION - Jim Maguire, The Corinthian Sailor

Jim, Commodore (1983) and President (1994-5) of CY&BC; as a keen sailor owned several bilge-keelers. These he cruised extensively including the Scottish Isles; and a single-handed circumnavigation of Ireland when in his 70s. Jim was a passionate mentor, and instrumental in training and coaching over many years embodying the camaraderie spirit of Corinthian Sailing.

In Jim's memory, his family presented the "Jim Maguire Trophy" in 2008 for the inaugural East Coast Bilge Keel Championship. The Championship is a short-format regatta to primarily provide the cruiser sailor an opportunity to race similarly minded folks and boats.

1. RULES AND ELIGIBILITY

1.1 The event is governed by the **Racing Rules of Sailing (RRS)**. Eligible boats must comply

- with the definition of a 'cruiser' in the ICRA Constitution
- Further (since this is a Bilge Keel Championship), have two or more non-retractable keels, not in a row (triple keel boats are acceptable)
- **This is a "White Sails Only" event – additional downwind sails are excluded.**
- Entries from CY&BC and non CY&BC qualifying boats will be accepted
- **Entry Fees** must be paid prior to Briefing, the latest, early (online) entry preferred.

1.2. Club Membership: All competitors will be granted honorary membership of the Club (CY&BC) for the duration of the event.

2. CHANGES TO SAILING INSTRUCTIONS AND NOTICES TO COMPETITORS

2.1 Any changes to the sailing instructions will be posted on the CY&BC Event Noticeboard (in clubhouse) 1.5 hours before the scheduled warning signal for the first race on the day.

- **Flag L** will be displayed from the Club Flagpole to indicate a change has been made.
- The RO (Race Officer) **may** opt to give instructions over **VHF (Ch 73)**.

3. SAFETY

3.1 An effective personal flotation device shall be worn by all on board, at all times.

3.2 A VHF radio tuned into **Channel 73** must be kept on.

4. HAZARDS

4.1 Dublin Port Shipping Channel

Shipping has right of way. Boats shall not sail in the shipping channel or river marked by Dublin Port.

Racing in the channel, is considered valid grounds for protest by the Race Committee. Please refer to Dublin Port pilotage for more information and navigation.

4.2 North Bull Wall (Half Tide Wall) & Entry to Dublin Port

The harbour entrance is marked by 2 lighthouses. The GREEN North Bull Wall lighthouse will appear isolated. There is a submerged (half tide) wall running out (north-west) to it from the shore. Racing is excluded between light-house and the shore (over the wall). Vessels are instructed to pass between Red and Green lighthouses when entering and leaving the port paying attention to shipping (see 4.1).



4.3 Submerged Hazard (Clontarf 2025)

If unaware please consult CY&BC. There is a submerged hazard marked by four buoys amongst the moorings, details are on club website www.cybc.ie

Coordinates: **52°21.454 N 006°11.480 W**

5. SCHEDULE OF RACES

5.1 A program of 3 races will be held over the one day of the event, weather-permitting.

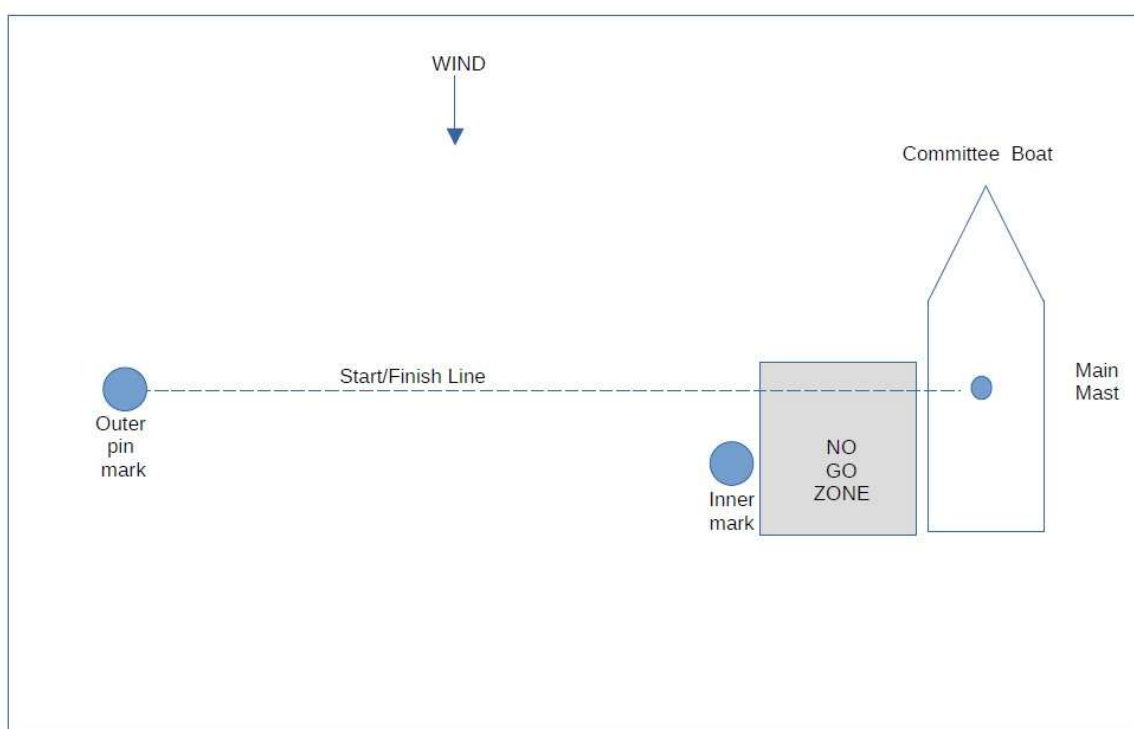
5.2 Races will be started as soon as possible after the last finisher or the elapse of race-time-limit.

6. RACE AREA

6.1 The sailing area shall be in Dublin Bay, north and east of the North Bull Lighthouse (north of shipping channel) between Clontarf and Sutton.

6.2 Per point 4, **no racing will occur in the Shipping Channel.**

7. THE START



7.1 **The start Line:** shall be between the mainmast of the committee boat and an Outer Pin-end mark, laid on port-side of the committee boat.

7.2 **Restrictions:** An **inner-limit mark** will be laid close to the committee boat; no boat shall pass between the inner limit buoy and the committee boat. **Any boat passing between will be (DSQ) disqualified from the Championship.** This inner-limit mark may be in front or behind the start line, OR leeward of the committee boat and does not form part of the start-line.

7.3 Collision with the Committee Boat

Any boat making physical-contact with the committee boat will immediately be disqualified (**DSQ**) from the Championship, and will leave the race area.

7.3 **Time Limit:** Boats starting later than 10 minutes after the starting signal will be scored DID NOT START (DNS).

7.4 **Start Sequence** is and signalled using flags:

- 1st Gun **5 mins** to go **Warning signal:** 'C' flag raised
- 2nd Gun **4 mins** to go **Preparatory signal :** 'P' Preparatory (**Blue Peter**)

- | | | |
|------------------------------------|------------------------|---|
| • 3 rd Gun 1 min to go | One minute | or alternative black/other flag raised |
| • 4 th Gun START | Starting signal | 'P' Preparatory flag lowered |
| | | 'C' flag lowered |

7.5 Other Starting Signals

The RO may optionally use sound signals to indicate start-sequence, or count-down on the VHF. **These are not obligatory**. This complies with Rule 26.

8. FINISH

8.1 The finish line will be the same line as the start line (unless race is shortened), It will be from the main-mast on the committee boat and a pin-end mark. Inner limit mark must be observed.

8.2 FINISHING: Boats will finish by crossing the finish-line **directly from direction of the last mark**. This may require boats to reach or run to the finish.

8.3 SHORTENED COURSE: Announcement

The RO may decide to Shorten Course (see rule RRS 32.1-3). This will be announced with

- **Flag S** raised on the committee boat
- **2 Sound Signals** will be made
- Optional announcement on VHF to the fleet

8.4 SHORTENED COURSE: Finish Line

In the event of a shortened race

- The finish line will be set up between a mark on the course, and a boat flying a "**BLUE**" flag.
- The line will run from the flagstaff of the boat (used for BLUE flag) to the course mark.
- The boat will be at anchor

9. RACE TIME LIMIT

9.1 The time limit for a race is 20 minutes after the ***fifth boat*** finishes.

9.2 All boats in the race failing to finish within the time-limit, will be scored **DNF** (Did Not Finish).

10. HANDICAPS & RESULTS

10.1 This is an open event. ECHO Handicap System will be used.

- **Valid ECHO Certificates:** will be accepted with the entry form
- **CY&BC Cruisers:** without ECHO Certificates will be assigned rating from club handicap system (HALSAIL)
- **Non CY&BC Cruisers:** without ECHO Certificates, nor previous rating from CY&BC; will be assigned an approximate/average handicap of same or similar boat-types from the CY&BC Fleet. CY&BC Race Officer will have final say on handicap applied.

10.2 Handicaps are progressive: they adjust on the basis of relative performance of boats in each race using ECHO progressive algorithm.

10.3 ECHO Blend: will be **25%** (CY&BC default value).

10.4 ECHO Blend: is the ratio of the handicap actually achieved in a race to the starting handicap when calculating the handicap to use for the next race.

10.5 RESULTS: CY&BC will generate and publish results online using HALSAIL. The results will be available at:

- <https://halsail.com/Result/Club/3526>
- See class: "REGATTA Cruisers"

11. SCORING

11.1 Series Scoring

Overall Championship win, will be based on results from **all races sailed**. **There is no discard**.

11.2 The low scoring system will apply. The boat coming first in each race will be awarded one point, the boat coming second will be awarded two points and so forth.

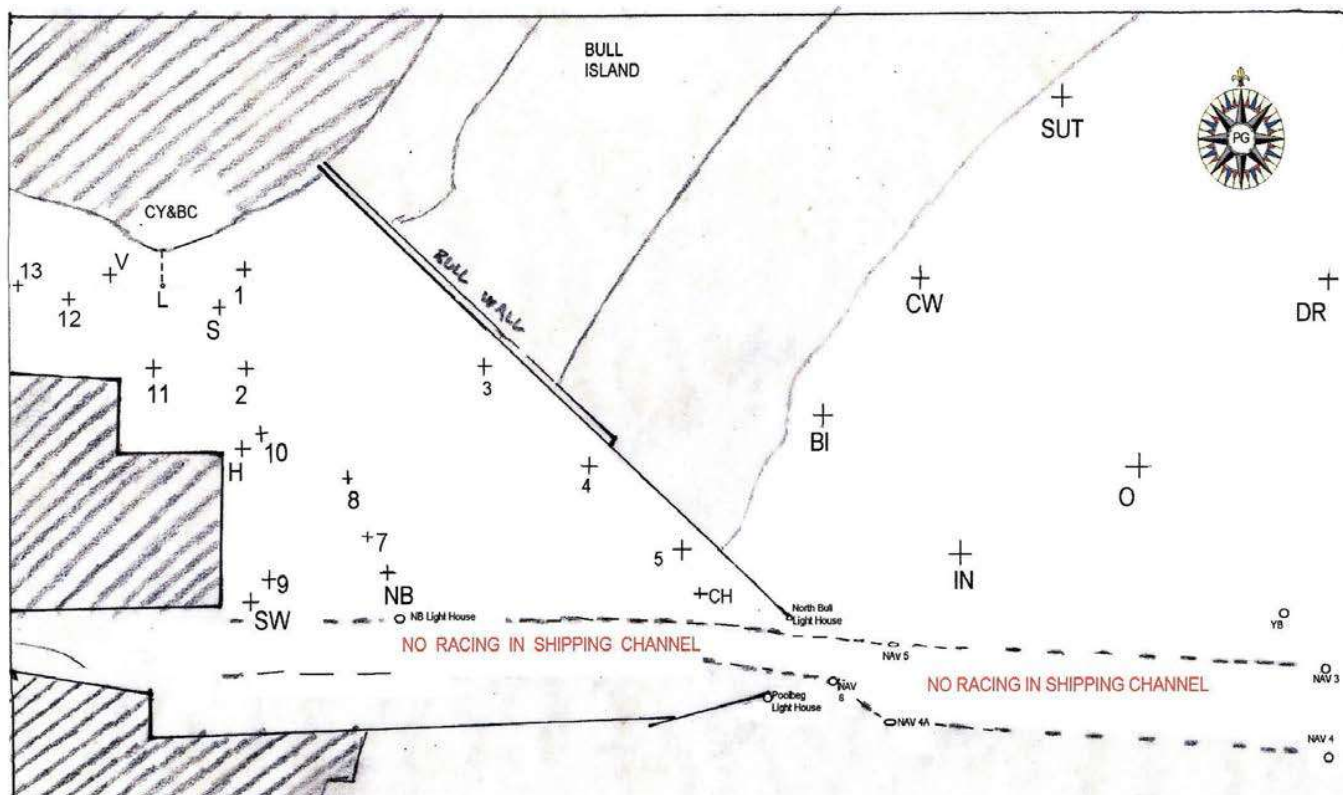
11.3 Other Notable Scoring

Boats may be awarded the following:

- **DNF (Did Not Finish):** points equal to the number of starters in the race
- **RET (Retired):** points equal to the number of starters in the race
- **DNS (Did Not Start):** points equal to **one point plus** the number of boats in the race
- **OCS (On Course Side):** points equal to **one point plus** the number of boats in the race
- **DNC (Did Not Come to the Course):** points equal to **one point plus** the number of **entrants** in the **Championship**
- **DSQ (Disqualified):** points equal to **two points** plus the number of entrants in the **Championship**.
- If **Black Flag** is used and boats are OCS, boats will be awarded **DSQ** (This complies with Rule 30.4)
- Other scoring points awarded at discretion of the RO

12. SAILING COURSES: Bay Courses

12.1 Course Card



HIGH WATER 'X1' COURSES

A1		B1		C1		D1		E1		F1		G1		H1	
North		North-East		East		South-East		South		South-West		West		North-West	
Start line		Start line		Start Line		Start Line		Start Line		Start Line		Start Line		Start Line	
CW	S	DR	P	O	P	IN	P	IN	P	IN	S	BI	S	BI	S
O	P	BI	S	CW	S	CW	S	SUT	S	SUT	P	DR	P	O	P
SUT	P	SUT	S	DR	S	O	P	O	S	BI	P	CW	P	CW	P
				O	S	SUT	S	IN	S	DR	S	BI	P	O	P
						DR	S							CW	P
Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line	

LOW WATER 'X2' COURSES

A2		B2		C2		D2		E2		F2		G2		H2	
North		North-East		East		South-East		South		South-West		West		North-West	
Start line		Start line		Start Line		Start Line		Start Line		Start Line		Start Line		Start Line	
SUT	P	DR		O	P	IN	P	O	P	IN	P	DR	P	SUT	P
IN	P	SUT		DR	P	SUT	S	DR	P	DR	P	IN	S	O	P
OUT	P	IN		IN	P	DR	S	SUT	P	SUT	P	SUT	S	DR	P
SUT	P	DR		O	P	O	S	O	P	O	P	DR	P	SUT	P
OUT	P							SUT	P	DR	P			DR	P
Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line		Finish Line	

Harbour Marks

- H = Hub
- S=Spit
- SW = South West.
- NB = North Bank
- CH = Churn

North Dublin Bay Marks

- IN = InnerMark
- O = Outer
- DR = Drumleck
- BI = Bull Island.
- CW = Causeway
- SUT = Sutton

12.2 Approx. positions for Dublin Bays Marks

Inner	53'20.80N	006'08.2W
Bull Island	53'21.10N	006'08.8W
Causeway	53'21.50N	006'08.4W
Sutton	53'21.80N	006'07.8W
Outer	53'21.00N	006'07.5W
Drumleck	53'21.40N	006'07.0W

If available, updated GPS positions will be posted on club noticeboard.

12.2 START-FINISH LINE & 1st LEG : the start-finish line will be laid downwind of the first mark of the course, providing a beat for the first-leg.

12.3 Notification of Courses: Courses will be displayed on the side of the Committee boat before the race-countdown is started. (This changes rule 27.1). The RO may also announce the race-course on the VHF.

13 CONDUCT WHEN RACING

13.1 FAIR PLAY and SPORTSMANSHIP It is anticipated there may be inexperienced competitors. The RRS sets expectations closely aligned with the Corinthian nature of the event. Racing requires honesty and is self-governing for the most part. See **RRS 2** "Fair Sailing", **RRS 42** "propulsion" and below **RRS 69.1** "**Obligation not to Commit Misconduct; Resolution**"

1. A competitor, boat owner or support person shall not commit an act of misconduct.
2. **Misconduct is:**
 1. conduct that is a **breach of good manners, a breach of good sportsmanship, or unethical behaviour**; or
 2. conduct that may bring, or has brought, the **sport into disrepute**.
3. **An allegation of a breach of rule 69.1(a) shall be resolved in accordance with the provisions of rule 69. It shall not be grounds for a protest.**

13.2 PENALTY TURNS: boats infringing rules will perform their penalties **as soon as safely possible**.

- If not taken swiftly (for example only at a distance / time later in the leg, or later in a location with favourable tide etc) this boat **may be further protested**. This complies with **RRS 44.2**.
- See also **RSS 21.2**. "A boat taking a penalty shall keep clear of one that is not."

13.3 Conduct: Backing Sails: is permitted but awareness of RSS 21.3 especially in start environment is necessary (even if on starboard).

- **RRS 21.3.** A boat moving astern, or sideways to windward, through the water by backing a sail shall keep clear of one that is not.

15. PROTESTS

14.1 Protest Flag: it is not necessary to carry a protest flag nor display a flag if protesting. **This changes RRS 60.2** (which states boats over 6 metres must display a protest flag).

14.2 Protesting Boat: must hail the offending boat at time of incident with hail "PROTEST",

- It is recommended to hail other boats who may be used as witnesses. This complies with **RRS 60.2**.
- Please see **RRS 60.2** for delivering a protest if protestee is not in hailing distance.

14.3 PROTEST DECLARATION A boat intending to protest shall,

- as soon as possible after finishing, inform the race committee or the finishing-mark boat of the sail number of the boat(s) protested and wait for an acknowledgement.
- Protest Hearing will be set up according to RRS (section A)

16. PRIZES AND TROPHIES REVIEW

16.1 The following prize will be awarded for winner of the Championship

- **Perpetual “Jim Maguire” Trophy for the East Coast Bilge Keel Championship**

17. RESPONSIBILITY

17.1 CY&BC, its officers and agents accept no responsibility for any damage to boats or for personal injury.

17.2 Competitors' attention is drawn to RRS Fundamental **Rule 3 & 4**, especially in relation to races being run in heavy weather.

17.3 All competing boats must carry adequate, valid, third-party, liability insurance cover.

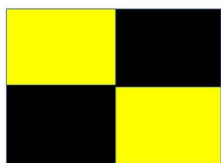
18. COMMUNICATIONS

18.1 The VHF **channel 73** will be used for announcements during the event.

18.2 Competitors are requested to pay attention to VHF particularly before starts for RO communications.

18.3 **FLAGS are used to signal the fleet.**

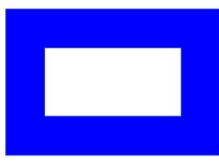
The RO may use but is not limited to the following flags. See RRS for full sets of flags. .



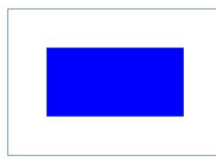
FLAG “L”
Change to SI
(Club Flagpole)



FLAG “C”
Cruiser Class



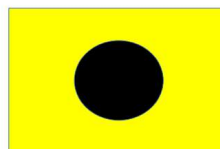
FLAG “P”
Preparatory



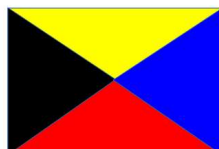
FLAG “S”
Shortened Course



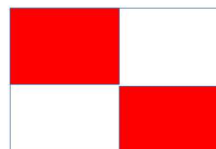
“BLACK” FLAG
Rule 30.4



FLAG “I”
Rule 30.1



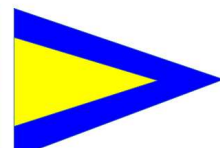
FLAG “Z”
Rule 30.2



FLAG “U”
Rule 30.3



FLAG “X”
Individual Recall



FLAG “1st Substitute”
General Recall

SUMMARY – instead of Preparatory:

I (30.1): boat OCS in -1min: whole hull must return pre-start side

Z (30.2): No part of boat in TRIANGLE of Line & 1st mark (in -1min)

= **immediate 20% penalty**

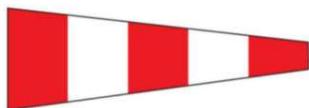
U (30.3): No part of boat in TRIANGLE of Line & 1st mark (in -1min):

= **Immediate DSQ**

(30.4): No part of boat in TRIANGLE of Line & 1st mark (in -1min)

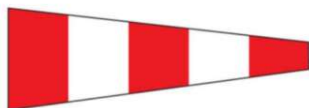
= **Immediate DSQ – not discard-able**

POSTPONEMENT SIGNALS



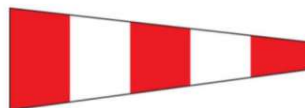
AP (Answering Pennant)
Postponement

Races not started are postponed.
Warning signal will be made 1 minute after removal unless at that time the race is postponed again or abandoned.



AP (Answering Pennant)
Over 'H'

Races not started are postponed.
Further signals ashore.



AP (Answering Pennant)
Over 'A'

Races not started are postponed.
No more racing today.

ABANDONMENT SIGNALS



FLAG 'N'

All races that have started are abandoned.
Return to the starting area.

The warning signal will be made 1 minute after removal unless at that time the race is abandoned again or postponed.



N over H
All races are abandoned.
Further signals ashore.



N over A
All races are abandoned.
No more racing today